

Reading

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A Tour of a Smart Classroom

Before you read

- Look at the title. What technology do you expect to read about?
- Guess: name two devices you think a 'smart classroom' might have.

Our school opened a new smart classroom this year, and I was one of the first students to try it. When you walk in, the first thing you notice is the huge interactive whiteboard at the front. It isn't just a screen — you can touch it, write on it, and even play educational games on it.

Every student has a small tablet connected to the classroom's wireless network. Worksheets are never printed on paper anymore; instead, they are downloaded from the school's online platform at the start of the lesson. If a device runs out of battery, there is a charger under every desk.

During our science lesson, the teacher used the projector to show a 3D model of the solar system. It looked almost like a hologram floating above the desks! Although the equipment is expensive, our headteacher says it will be upgraded again next year with new, more innovative tools.

Of course, technology sometimes causes problems. Last week, the Wi-Fi went down, so we couldn't upload our homework on time. Because of this, our teacher taught us to always keep a backup copy. Students must also charge their tablets themselves every night — nobody does it for us!

I really enjoy learning in the smart classroom because lessons feel more interactive and modern. However, I still think a good teacher is more important than any device, no matter how advanced it is.

1. What is the text mainly about?

- a. A student's experience of a smart classroom
- b. How to repair a broken projector
- c. The history of the interactive whiteboard

2. What is under every desk?

- a. A charger
- b. A router
- c. A printer

3. What happened when the Wi-Fi went down?

- a. The lesson finished early
- b. Students couldn't upload their homework on time
- c. The whiteboard stopped working

4. In paragraph 3, what does 'it' in 'It looked almost like a hologram' refer to?

- a. The projector
- b. The 3D model of the solar system
- c. The interactive whiteboard

5. According to the text, the writer thinks technology is more important than a good teacher. — *True / False*

6. Whose job is it to charge the tablets every night?

- a. The caretaker's
- b. The students' own job
- c. The IT teacher's

After you read

- What technology would you like to have in your own classroom? Write two sentences.
- Compare the smart classroom in the text with your own classroom. Find one similarity and one difference.

My Two Weeks with a Learning App

Before you read

- Do you use any apps to help you study? Which ones?
- Predict: what problems could someone have when they start using a new learning app?

Two weeks ago, my English teacher recommended a new vocabulary app for our class project. At first, I found it a little confusing, but I taught myself how to use it in about ten minutes by watching a short video.

Every evening, I open the app on my phone and review ten new words. The app updates my progress automatically, so I can see exactly which words I need to practise again. Because the app tracks my mistakes, it gives me more practice with the words I find difficult.

Although I enjoy the app, it isn't perfect. Sometimes it needs an internet connection, so I can't use it on the school bus where there is no Wi-Fi. When this happens, I use paper flashcards instead — an old method that still works well!

For our technology project, our group decided to create a short guide for other students about using learning apps responsibly. We explained that apps are a great tool, but students shouldn't only rely on a screen; talking to real people is important too.

After two weeks, I can say the app really helped me learn new words faster. I will keep using it, but I will also keep talking, reading and writing in English every day — technology should support learning, not replace it.

1. What is the text mainly about?

- a. A review of a school's technology equipment
- b. A student's diary about learning with an app
- c. Instructions for installing an app

2. How did the writer learn to use the app?

- a. A teacher explained it in class
- b. They taught themselves by watching a video
- c. A friend showed them at home

3. Why does the writer sometimes use paper flashcards?

- a. The app is too easy
- b. There is no Wi-Fi on the school bus
- c. The teacher doesn't allow phones

4. What was the group's technology project about?

- a. Building a robot
- b. A guide about using learning apps responsibly
- c. Designing a new classroom

5. The writer believes technology should completely replace talking, reading and writing. — *True / False*

6. How does the writer probably feel about the app after two weeks?

- a. Disappointed
- b. Positive, but realistic about its limits
- c. Bored

After you read

- Would you like to try a vocabulary app like this? Why or why not?
- Write one rule you would add to a 'using learning apps responsibly' guide.